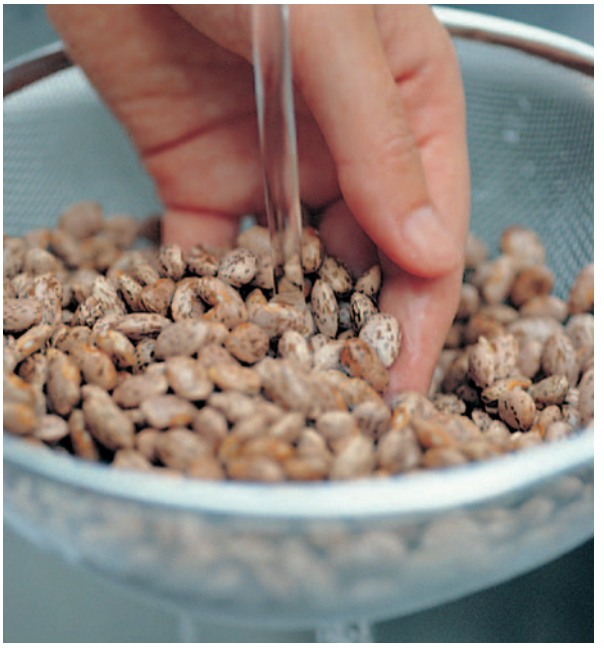
Dried beans, peas, and lentils are perfect for soup-making. Little effort is required to prepare them—all you need to do is think ahead.

preparing legumes

The basic preparation of legumes is simple: first, you need to sort and rinse them; then (in nearly all cases) you need to soak them; finally, the legumes have to be cooked until tender. This can take anywhere from around half an hour to 3 hours. Once cooked, legumes are well-suited to puréeing, but they also work well left whole in soups.

sorting and rinsing



Whatever kind of legume you're using, start by sorting and rinsing them. Place the legumes in a colander and carefully pick out any husks or pieces of grit, then rinse the legumes well under cold running water.

soaking



Apart from lentils and split peas, all legumes need to be soaked for at least 8 hours, and preferably overnight. Place them in a bowl, add three times their volume of cold water, then cover and place in the refrigerator.